

Lists

If you need to keep lots of data in one place, then you can put it in a list. Lists can contain numbers, strings, other lists, or a combination of all these things.

SEE ALSO

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Silly **132–133** ▶
sentences

What is a list?

A list is a structure in Python where items are kept in order. Each entry is given a number that you can use to refer back to it. You can change, delete, or add to the items in a list at any point.

▽ Looking at lists

Each item in a list sits inside single quote marks, and is separated from the next item by a comma. The whole list sits inside a pair of square brackets.

```
>>> mylist = ['apple', 'milk', 'cheese', 'icecream', \
              'lemonade', 'tea']
```

The list is stored in the variable "mylist"

The items in a list are separated by commas

This character is used to make code go over two lines

The items in the list sit inside a pair of square brackets

▷ How it works

You can think of a list as a row of shelves in a kitchen. Each shelf holds one item from the list. To make changes to an item, you must refer to the shelf it is on.

